

LINUX ON YOUR DESKTOP

Want to change everything about your Linux desktop? Experiment with the desktop environment and the window manager to get the best look and feel for your Linux distribution

Changing the default desktop environment

If you have both KDE and Gnome desktops then switching desktops is something you might feel like doing on and off. The simplest method is to run the command switchdesk from the terminal window. It not only allows you to switch desktops but also lets you specify different desktops with different displays.

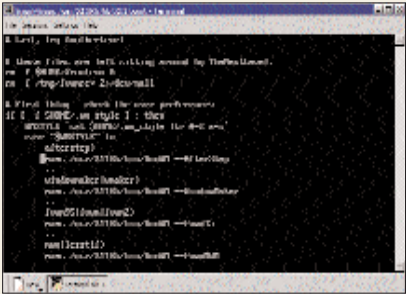


Change the desktop to the one of your liking

Changing your window manager from the terminal

If you want to change your window manager from the terminal, all you have to do is open the Xclients file in your terminal window and add a single line there in order to change the window manager that will open by default. Once you have opened the Xclients file in your text editor, just add a single line that says `usr/X11R6/bin/RunWM.'yourwindowmanager'`. Replace 'yourwindowmanager' with one of your choice, either WindowMaker or AfterStep or Enlightenment.

Note that you need to have these window managers installed to have it up and running. Also remember to change the

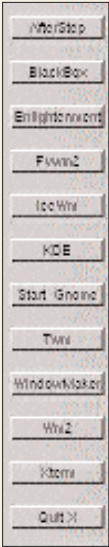


Use the terminal to change your window manager

Xclients file present in your home directory and not the one at `/usr/X11R6/lib/X11/Xinit/Xclients`. Changing the configuration in this file changes the default for all users and that's something you might not want.

Changing your window manager in Gnome or KDE

Changing the window manager in Gnome is quite simple. Go to the Settings options and select Gnome Control Center. In the Control Center, go to the Window Manager option. Select the window manager you want and click on Try to make it the default.



If you want, you can add window managers to the list through the Add button and by specifying the path. In KDE, you can use the terminal window, and use the command `kwmcom go:window manager` to specify the window manager that you want to use. However, you must first ensure that you have `kwmcom` installed.

Alternatively, you can

Use guichosser to change window managers

KDE Keyboard Shortcuts

- [Alt] + [Esc] or [Control] + [Esc]: You get the KDE session manager using which you can either switch to a specific application or log out of KDE
- [Alt] + [Tab] or [Alt] + [Shift] + [Tab]: This switches between all the open windows
- [Ctrl] + [Tab] or [Ctrl] + [Shift] + [Tab]: Switches between your desktops
- [Alt] + [F2]: Opens the run terminal to execute programs
- [Alt] + [F3]: Gives you the window menu for the application
- [Alt] + [F4]: Closes the window you are currently working on
- [Ctrl] + [F1] to [F8]: Switches to the desktop number
- [Ctrl] + [Alt] + [Esc]: Closes all the open windows
- [Ctrl] + [Alt] + [Numpad +]: Moves to the next available screen resolution
- [Ctrl] + [Alt] + [Numpad -]: Moves to the previous screen resolution

KDE Mouse Shortcuts

- Clicking on border or the title bar: Left-click activates and raises the window, centre-click activates and lowers the window, while right-click shows window menu if it is active and if not, activates it.
- Double-clicking on the window title: Maximises the window
- Dragging on edges: Resizes the window
- [Alt] + Left-click: Moves the window around
- [Alt] + centre-click: Raises the window
- [Alt] + right-click: Resizes the window
- Clicking on the top-left icon: Pops the window menu
- Clicking on Maximize: Left-click maximises the window, centre-click maximises only vertically while right-click maximises horizontally.

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